

Web Application User Guide

Mpaebo Bea — Place of Prayer

Complete guide to the church management portal • Version 2.0 • Desktop and mobile

Contents

- | | |
|------------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1. Introduction | 10. Events |
| 2. User roles | 11. Organisations |
| 3. Getting started | 12. Receipts |
| 4. Moving around the app | 13. Reports |
| 5. Public pages for visitors | 14. Statistics |
| 6. Dashboard | 15. Calculator |
| 7. Members | 16. Church Profile |
| 8. Finances | 17. My Profile |
| 9. Announcements | 18. Offline mode & PWA |
| | 19. Troubleshooting & tips |

1. Introduction

The **Mt. Olivet Methodist Church web application** is an all-in-one church management and information portal. It connects the church community in one place: visitors can learn about the church, members can stay up to date and take part, and leaders can manage the church's people, money, notices and activities.

What the app does

- Manages the **member directory** — contact details, dates, roles and organisations.
- Tracks **finances** — donations, expenses, summaries and reports.
- Publishes **announcements** and the **weekly service** details.
- Schedules **events** and records **attendance**.
- Runs **organisations (ministries)** with members, events and picture galleries.
- Issues and stores **donation receipts** (viewable and downloadable as PDF).
- Tracks **weekly attendance statistics**.
- Provides a public **About the Church** page for everyone.

How it works

- It is a **web app (PWA)** — open it in any modern browser on your computer or phone.
- It can be **installed** on your phone or desktop and used **even without an internet connection**.
- Changes made offline are saved and **synced automatically** when you are back online.

2. User roles

Each account has a role that controls what the user can see and do. When you log in, your role is shown as a badge in the top bar.

Role	Badge shown as	What they can do
Admin	Steward	Everything: manage members and their accounts, finances, announcements, events, organisations, statistics, the church profile and the system About page.
Reverend	Reverend	Manage members and reports, view financial information, view statistics, and all member features.
Finance Officer	Finance Officer	Record and manage donations and expenses, manage receipts, use the Calculator, and all member features.
Member	Member	Personal dashboard, join organisations, read announcements and events, view own receipts and statistics.

Menus adapt to the role automatically — only features you are allowed to use appear in the navigation.

3. Getting started

3.1 Creating an account (members)

- 1 Open the app and click **Create Account** on the home page (or go to the Login page and click "Create a new account").
- 2 Fill in your **full name**, choose a **username** and a **password** (at least 8 characters).
- 3 Optionally add your **email** and **phone number**.
- 4 Submit. Your Member account is created and you are logged in automatically.

Note: Self-registration always creates a **Member** account. Staff accounts (Reverend, Finance Officer, Admin/Steward) are created by an administrator.

3.2 First login with a temporary password

When an administrator creates an account for you, a temporary password is generated. The first time you log in, the app will require you to **choose your own password** before you can continue:

- 1 Log in with your username and the temporary password.
- 2 You are taken to the **Change Your Password** screen.
- 3 Enter your current password, your new password (at least 8 characters) and confirm it.
- 4 Save — you are now in the portal. From then on you log in with your own password.

3.3 Logging in and out

- **Log in:** enter your username and password on the Login page and press Log In. You will be greeted with "Welcome back!".
- **Log out:** click the logout icon in the top bar and confirm. You are returned to the home page.

4. Moving around the app

- **Top bar:** shows the current page, your connection status ([Online](#) / [Offline](#)), any pending offline changes, a **Sync** button when changes are waiting, the dark/light mode toggle, your role badge and username, and the logout button.
- **Desktop:** a navigation rail on the left lists all the pages you can access.
- **Mobile:** a bottom bar shows the first four items plus a **More** button that opens the full menu in a sheet.

5. Public pages for visitors

No login is needed for these pages — they are open to everyone.

5.1 Home page (Landing)

- Hero section with the church name and slogan, plus buttons to log in, register, read about the church, or open the dashboard.
- Community statistics: **Organisations**, **Weekly Activities**, **Upcoming Events** and **Announcements**.
- Feature cards linking to the member directory, finances, receipts, announcements, events & attendance, and organisations.
- A “Come Worship With Us” band with the church’s social media links.

5.2 About the Church

- Five tabs: **About Us**, **Organisations**, **Activities**, **Events** (upcoming) and **Announcements** (active notices with priority tags and expiry dates).
- Clicking a card opens a **detail page** with the full description, any related events and a **picture gallery**.
- Click any photo to view it in a lightbox; a **Download image** button lets you save it (with a confirmation).

6. Dashboard

The first page after logging in.

- Personal greeting with your role badge.
- Stat cards: **Members**, **Today's Offering**, **Monthly Tithe** and **Balance**. The financial cards appear only for Admin, Finance Officer and Reverend.
- **Upcoming Events** card — admins get a "Manage" link for each event.
- **Latest Announcements** card showing the newest notices with priority tags.

7. Members Staff

Manage the member directory (available to Staff: Admin, Finance Officer, Reverend).

- **Search** members by name, username, email or phone.
- **Add Member** (Admin): enter the full details and choose a role. The password can be typed or **generated randomly** — generated passwords force the member to set their own password at first login.
- **Edit** (Admin): update any details. The username cannot be changed.
- **Delete** (Admin): remove a member's account after confirmation. You cannot delete your own account.
- **View**: open a member's full profile, including the organisations they belong to and their role in each.

8. Finances Staff

Three tabs: **Donations**, **Expenses** and **Summary**.

8.1 Donations

- **Record Donation** (Admin / Finance): pick the member, amount, category (Tithe, Offering, MDF, Appeals, Donations, Harvest, Pledge, Project Fund, Grace Box, Other), payment method (Cash, Mobile Money, Bank Transfer, Cheque), reference, date and notes.
- Categories such as Tithe, Donations and Pledge are recorded for a specific member; the rest apply to the whole church ("All Members").
- Filter by **date range** with a running total of the filtered amount.

8.2 Expenses

- **Record Expense** (Admin / Finance): amount, category (Utilities, Salaries, Repairs, Transport, Food, Supplies, Rent, Outreach, Other), description and date.
- **Edit** or **Delete** each expense with confirmation. An "Approved by" column shows who recorded it.

8.3 Summary

- Total **Income**, **Expenses** and **Balance** cards.
- Income and expense breakdowns **by category**.
- **Monthly Report** table for all 12 months with a year picker.
- **Delete all donations for a year** (Admin only, with confirmation).

Pastor read-only The Reverend can view finances but only Admin and the Finance Officer can record or change entries.

9. Announcements

- **New Announcement** (Admin): title, priority (**Normal / Urgent / High / Low**), content and an optional expiry date.
- **Edit / Delete** announcements (Admin) with confirmation.
- **This Week's Service** (Admin): upload the service date, preacher and bible reading, and edit or delete past entries.
- Members see the current active announcements; staff can also view expired/hidden ones.

10. Events

- **New Event** (Admin): title, description, event date, optional end date for multi-day events, location, and a **recurring** option with a weekday picker (Sunday–Saturday).
- **Edit / Delete** events (Admin).
- **Attendance** (Admin): for each event, add a member and mark them **Present**, **Absent** or **Excused**.
- Events show automatic status badges: **Upcoming**, **Started** or **Past**, and recurring events are labelled.

11. Organisations Everyone

Organisations (ministries / fellowships) are open to all members.

- **View** the list of organisations with their leaders and member counts.
- **Join** an organisation and choose the role you are joining as (for example Member, President or Secretary). **Leave** anytime.
- **Manage members** (Admin): add members, change roles inline and remove members.
- **Create / Edit / Delete** organisations (Admin): name, description, leader and the list of roles (e.g. *Member, President, Secretary*).

Organisation detail (opened by clicking a card)

- **Events tab:** upcoming and past events for the organisation, with add / edit / delete.
- **Pictures tab:**
 - Upload **multiple pictures at once** with a single caption (e.g. "Choir outing").
 - Previews appear instantly; you can remove any picture before uploading.
 - Delete pictures, or click one to view it in a lightbox with the uploader's name.

Note: Managing an organisation's events and pictures is allowed for Admins and for the current user whose role in that organisation is **Secretary**.

12. Receipts

All logged-in members can view donation receipts. Admin and Finance can also delete (hide) them.

- The list shows the **receipt number** (e.g. RCP-000123), date, donor, category, method and amount.
- **View** opens a neat HTML receipt preview inside the page, with a **Download PDF** button.
- **PDF** downloads the receipt as a file you can print or share.
- **Delete** hides the receipt from your list (confirmed first).

13. Reports Staff

- Filters: **year**, **period** (Yearly / Monthly / All time) and a **month** picker.
- **Monthly Report**: 12-month table of income, expenses and balance.
- **Income by Category** and **Top Donors** lists.
- **Donor Summary**: a modal table showing each donor, number of donations, total amount and last donation date for the selected period.
- **Delete Period** (Admin only): permanently deletes all donations for the selected period — use with care.

14. Statistics

- **Attendance Trend:** a chart of attendance per service, broken into **Adult Men, Adult Women, Boys** and **Girls**.
- **Record Attendance** (Admin): service date, counts for each group and an optional note. Re-recording for the same date updates it.
- **Edit / Delete** attendance rows (Admin).
- The table shows the total per service automatically and who recorded it.

15. Calculator Admin / Finance

A simple offline calculator for quick arithmetic — basic operations, percentages, sign change, clear and chained calculations.

16. Church Profile Admin

Edit everything shown to the public on the home and About pages. Each tab has its own **Save Changes** button.

- **General:** church **name**, **tagline** and **logo** (upload, change or remove).
- **About / Mission:** add or remove sections, each with a title and content, and upload **multiple images with captions** per section.
- **Organisations:** add or remove public organisation entries (title, subtitle, description) with pictures and captions.
- **Activities:** add or remove weekly activities (title, subtitle, description).
- **Social Media:** phone, WhatsApp, email, Facebook and TikTok — shown as icons on the public pages.

17. My Profile

Available to every logged-in user.

- **Account card:** your full name, username, email, phone and role.
- **Edit Profile:** update your name, username, email, phone, gender, date of birth, family name, baptism date, membership date and address. Your **role cannot be changed** here.
- **Change Password:** current password plus a new one (at least 8 characters).
- **Appearance:** switch between light and dark mode, and pick a **theme colour** from the palette. Admins can also set the default theme for the whole app.

18. Offline mode & PWA

Install the app

- **Phone:** use the browser's "Add to Home Screen" option — the app then opens full-screen like a native app.
 - **Desktop:** install it from the browser menu (Chrome / Edge install button).
- The app shell and its pages are cached, so the portal **opens even without internet**.
 - Actions you perform while offline (e.g. adding a donation or an announcement) are **queued locally**. The top bar shows how many changes are pending.
 - Queued changes **sync automatically**: when you reconnect, every 30 seconds while online, or when you press the **Sync** button.
 - The top bar always shows whether you are **Online** or **Offline**.

Note: Logging in and joining/leaving organisations need a connection. Receipt previews show a friendly message if you try to view them offline.

19. Troubleshooting & tips

Situation	What to do
Password not accepted	Passwords must be at least 8 characters. The Register, forced-password and change-password screens all enforce this.
I cannot upload a picture	Choose image files only. Uploads are compressed automatically; if a particular file cannot be read, that file is skipped and you are notified, while the others upload.
Changes I made are missing	If you were offline, press Sync or wait for the automatic sync, then refresh.
I still see an old version of the app	Refresh the page, or close and reopen the app so it downloads the latest update.
I don't see a menu item	That feature is not available for your role. Ask an administrator (Steward) if you think it should be.
Someone else used my device	Use the Log out button (it asks for confirmation) whenever you finish.